

Rho Persei
360 Suns

Epsilon Persei
2,310 Suns

Zeta Persei
3,380 Suns

Mirphak
4,040 Suns

Mirphak (α Persei)
At magnitude 1.8, Mirphak is the brightest star in Perseus. It is surrounded by a loose cluster of dimmer stars

NGC 1528
An open cluster, NGC 1528 was discovered in 1790 by the British astronomer William Herschel. Consisting of about 160 stars, the cluster can be seen with binoculars

Zeta (ζ) Persei
Lying about 750 light-years away, Zeta Persei is a blue supergiant that is about 3,400 times more luminous than the Sun

M34
Lying about 1,400 light-years away, M34 is a large open cluster of about 60 stars

Algol (β Persei)
An eclipsing binary star, Algol fades from magnitude 2.1 to 3.4 for 10 hours every 2.9 days

Star distances

At about 90 light-years away, Algol is the nearest of Perseus's main pattern stars and the nearer of the constellation's two brightest stars. Mirphak is more than five times farther away, at 500 light-years, but is the brighter of the two. Xi is the most distant of the constellation's main pattern stars, situated about 1,240 light-years away.

